

Digital Literacy

Project Report

CSE0001 – Digital Literacy

Name:- Shashank Kumar

Registration number :- 25BME10012

Branch :- Mechanical (Core) – B.Tech

VIT Bhopal University

Introduction

This project is part of the CSE0001 Digital Literacy course at VIT Bhopal University. As a first year student stepping into the digital world, there are a lot of things that nobody really teaches you formally — how to build a professional profile, write a proper email, or stay safe online. This project covers all of that through five practical tasks. Each task pushed me to actually do something rather than just read about it, which made the learning feel genuinely useful.

Task 1 — Digital Literacy Awareness Infographic

I used Canva to design a one page infographic covering what digital literacy means, useful tools for students, and safe internet practices. The hardest part was that most good images on Canva are behind a premium subscription so finding free alternatives took time. The interesting part was discovering new features as I built it — the design genuinely got better the further I went.

Task 2 — Student Digital Portfolio

I set up profiles on GitHub, LinkedIn, and Stack Overflow. GitHub is where my code and projects will live, LinkedIn is for professional networking and internship opportunities, and Stack Overflow is where I will look up solutions and eventually contribute answers as I learn more. Setting these up in first year feels like a head start most students don't take until it's too late.

Task 3 — Coding & Collaboration Platforms

For Part A I completed an intermediate C++ challenge on HackerRank which was a good reality check — competitive programming requires a different mindset from just learning syntax. For Part B I built a 5 question Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz on Google Forms with multiple choice and short answer questions. Designing questions

that were clear and not too easy took more thought than I expected.

Task 4 — Professional Email & Etiquette Guide

A college student once posted a rant about their professor on a public Instagram story. It got screenshot, shared in college groups, and eventually reached the faculty — leading to disciplinary action. A simple private email to the professor would have been the right move. This task was a reminder that digital communication leaves a permanent trail and the wrong platform can turn a small frustration into a real problem.

Task 5 — Cybercrime Awareness

What surprised me most was how sophisticated UPI fraud has become — criminals can clone your voice using just a “hello” recorded on a call and use it to trick your own family. We tend to think we are too smart to fall for scams but that overconfidence is exactly what fraudsters count on. The one habit I will personally change is always verifying through a callback before transferring any money to anyone.

Conclusion

This project was more useful than I expected. Every task pushed me to actually build or set something up rather than just read about it. I now have a proper digital presence, a better understanding of professional communication, and a much sharper awareness of online safety. The biggest takeaway is that your digital footprint starts from day one of college and the earlier you take it seriously the better it gets.

References

- Canva — canva.com
- GitHub — github.com
- LinkedIn — linkedin.com
- Kaggle — kaggle.com
- HackerRank — hackerrank.com
- Google Forms — forms.google.com
- National Cyber Crime Portal — cybercrime.gov.in
- Cyber Crime Helpline — 1930 (24x7)